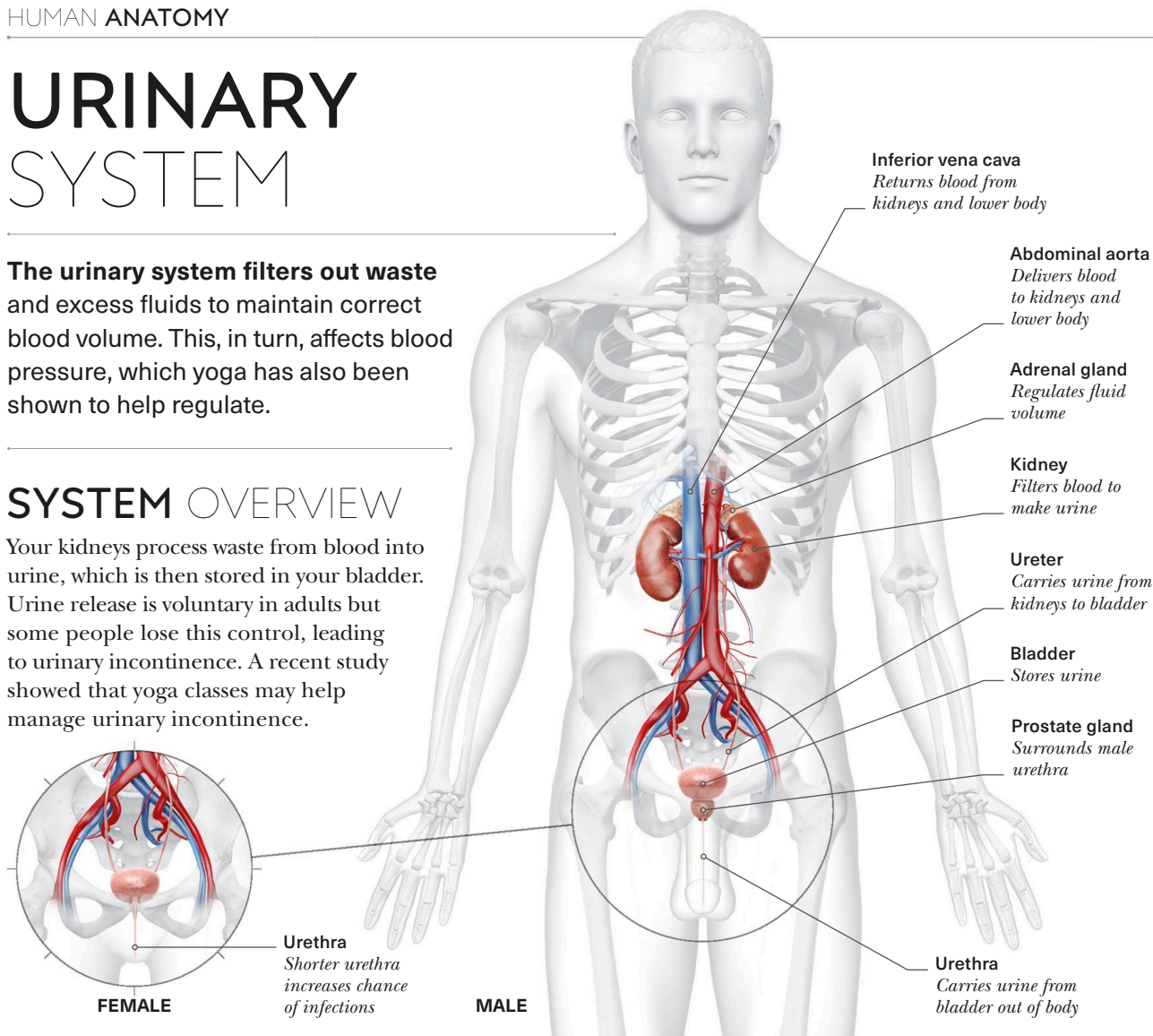


URINARY SYSTEM

The urinary system filters out waste and excess fluids to maintain correct blood volume. This, in turn, affects blood pressure, which yoga has also been shown to help regulate.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Your kidneys process waste from blood into urine, which is then stored in your bladder. Urine release is voluntary in adults but some people lose this control, leading to urinary incontinence. A recent study showed that yoga classes may help manage urinary incontinence.



Pelvic floor muscles

Your pelvic floor muscles are vital for bladder control. Common issues such as frequent, urgent, or painful urination, or slight leaking—such as when sneezing or laughing—may be helped by yoga exercises. For example, a gentle version of *mula bandha* (see p.153) and relaxation practices could improve pelvic floor health.

